SEO Strategy 2026: The Applicability of Performance SEO to Small Businesses

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- Maurice Marinelli
  - Performance SEO
  - Search Traffic = Margin
  - Page = Monetary Result
- Context
  - D2C, Shopify, DACH services
  - Teams and budgets
- Strategic shifts
  - Multichannel search
  - Commercial architecture
  - Reputation management

Nine market signals

- Search ≠ Google
  - AI search, aggregators
  - Local platforms
- Classic SEO = foundation
  - Indexing
  - URL structure
  - No duplicates
- KPI = money
  - Calls
  - Applications
- Info content without data
  - Zero clicks
  - Unique cases
- Search Reputation
  - Reviews
  - Responses to negativity
- GEO
  - Page refinement
  - Clear language
- Link building
  - Local mentions
  - Refusal of packages
- Product quality
  - Signal amplification
- Structured data
  - LocalBusiness
  - Service
  - Review

Applicability to Handwerksbetrieb

- Full
  - KPI = money
  - Technical foundation
  - Quality of work
- Partial
  - Multichannel
  - Link building
  - Markup
- Critical
  - Review management
- Minimal
  - GEO optimization
- Not applicable
  - AI visibility platforms
  - Wikipedia
  - Large-scale matrices

Infrastructure vs. Marketing

- Infrastructure
  - Indexed pages
  - Correct redirects
  - Structured data
  - Google Business Profile
  - Access control
- Marketing
  - Specific service descriptions
  - Systematic review collection
  - Photos of real objects
- Legal layer
  - Impressum
  - Datenschutzerklärung
- Monitoring
  - Search Console
  - Error checking

Minimum digital base

- Page architecture
  - Service = separate page
  - City = separate entry point
- Managed reviews
  - 2–4 per month
  - Responses are mandatory
- Technical correctness
  - Sitemap
  - Mobile version
  - Speed
- Structured data
  - LocalBusiness
  - Service
- KPI control
  - Separate number
  - UTM tags

Scale limit

- Enterprise level
  - Merchant Center
  - AI matrices
  - Mass SEO
- Rational core
  - Service-oriented architecture
  - Reputation as an asset
  - Stable infrastructure
- Strategic position
  - Flow stabilization
  - Controlled growth
  - Risk minimization